

John Campbell Thomas

Software Studio Founder · AI Engineer · USCG Master Captain

“Production AI on Anthropic Claude. Six products live. Built in Honolulu, shipped worldwide.”

fjordsadventures@gmail.com · (907) 769-1165 · 440 Lewers Street, Unit 603, Honolulu, HI 96815 · [ikenagroup.com](#) · [github.com/portofcams](#)

6

AI PRODUCTS LIVE

56M+

LINES TYPESCRIPT

8K/mo

CLAUDE CALLS

1,000+

SEA DAYS · 100T **USCG**

SUMMARY

Operator-engineer running a one-person software studio in Honolulu that ships AI-native web products on the Anthropic Claude API. Six surfaces live or in private beta — multi-tenant SaaS, iOS LiDAR, Hawaii data platform, subscription product, gated AI demo. Ten years operating real businesses before writing first production code: 100-ton USCG Master with 1,000+ sea days, Alaskan timber-frame and Honolulu finish carpentry, commercial dive ops, alpine fleet management. Trades-fluent founder shipping production AI is a rare profile. Looking for forward-deployed, founding-engineer, or developer-advocate roles where that overlap is the moat.

IN THE CODE

AI-Native Studio
Ikena Design & Build, LLC. Six products on Claude. Next.js, FastAPI, Postgres, Swift, Cloudflare, Vultr.

ON THE WATER

USCG Master 100T
1,000+ sea days, Alaska to Hawaii. Towing, salvage, charter, commercial dive, sail.

ON THE GROUND

Operator-Founder
Multi-company P&L. Crews of 10+ in maritime and alpine ops. Built and ran an LLC end-to-end.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE · SOFTWARE

Founder & Engineer — Ikena Design & Build, LLC

2024 — CURRENT

Honolulu, Hawaii · [ikenagroup.com](#)

One-person software studio shipping AI-native web products on Anthropic Claude. Six surfaces live or in private beta as of June 2026.

BlueWave Projects — Multi-tenant SaaS for general contractors. AI scope generation, client portal, e-sign (DocuSeal), Stripe billing, change orders, supplier ledgers. Sole engineer + designer + operator. Stack: Next.js 16, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Anthropic Claude.

Binnacle AI — Multi-tenant maritime crew-compliance SaaS. [binnacleai.com](#). Credential tracking (MMC / TWIC / medical / STCW), expiration flagging, sea-service parsing, and CFR Part 10/11 eligibility, with Claude Vision document classification. Live gated demo: NDA-veiled surfaces, admin queue, token-gated tenants, watermarked sessions.

hawaii-as-code — Statewide property data platform. 384,262 TMK parcels, 239,458 Honolulu building footprints with real heights, 204,775 address points — encoded as TypeScript, 56M+ lines of generated code. MapLibre GL frontend, zero-dependency Node backend. Live at [maps.ikenagroup.com](#).

Property Brief — Weekly homeowner subscription product, \$15/mo, automated email pipeline, Stripe billing. Live.

Aloha Network — Off-market real estate signals for Hawaii investors. \$99 / \$499 / \$1,500 founding-member tiers. Waitlist + Stripe pre-launch.

ProBuildCalc — Native iOS LiDAR scanner with Claude-powered estimating. Apple RoomPlan + Object Capture. Private TestFlight.

Production AI footprint: roughly 8,000 Claude API calls/month across the portfolio with documented patterns for inline-generative, async-generative, classification, and tool-using-agent loops. Aggressive prompt caching driving ~80% input-token cost reduction.

`next.js · react · astro · fastapi · postgres · anthropic-claude (haiku/sonnet/opus) · swift · swiftui · roomplan · cloudflare (pages/workers/email) · vultr · stripe · docuseal · resend`

TECHNICAL STACK

LANGUAGES

TypeScript · Python · Swift · SQL · Bash

BACKEND

FastAPI · Node · PostgreSQL · Redis

FRONTEND

Next.js · React · Astro · Tailwind · MapLibre GL

AI

Anthropic Claude (direct SDK) · Prompt caching · Tool-use · Streaming

IOS	Swift · SwiftUI · RoomPlan · Object Capture · ARKit	INFRA	Cloudflare Pages/Workers · Vultr · Docker · Nginx Proxy Manager
PAYMENTS	Stripe (billing, subs, multi-tier) · DocuSeal · Resend	DEVOPS	GitHub · Cursor · CI auto-deploy · Cloudflare Pages git auto-build
DATA	ArcGIS REST · OSM Overpass · NOAA NDBC · USPS · TMK/parcel data	PATTERNS	Multi-tenant SaaS · Token-gated demos · RAG · Webhooks · Cron pipelines

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE · OPERATIONS & MARITIME

USCG Master Captain · Sales Manager APR 2025 — NOV 2025

Ohana Boats Sales & Hawaii Boat Club · Honolulu, HI

- Managed fleet of 12+ private and club vessels at 100% USCG and local regulatory compliance.
- Coordinated maintenance, repairs, and charter scheduling; cut downtime 15% via proactive inspection cadence.
- Trained and supervised deck crews; standardized safety procedures and emergency response drills.

Senior Tow & Salvage Master Captain AUG 2021 — JUN 2023

Sea Tow International · Seward, AK & San Diego, CA

- Navigated complex Alaskan coastal waters in every season; expert use of local charts, currents, and maritime regulations.
- Vessel tows, salvage, marine emergency rescue across Alaskan and Californian waters.

Founder · Charter Operations · Captain APR 2020 — MAY 2024

Fjords Adventures, LLC · Seward, AK

- Built and ran the LLC end-to-end — bookings, marketing, regulatory paperwork, captain ops.
- Impeccable USCG and federal/national park maritime compliance; exemplary safety record across all charters and inspections.

Operations Manager · Captain · Lead Mechanic · Dive Supervisor JUN 2021 — AUG 2023

Storm Chasers Shipyard · Seward, AK

- Directed commercial dive operations in demanding environments — underwater construction, hydro-sync lifts, pipelines, offshore structures.
- Led crew of shipyard laborers through a variety of vessel projects on time and safely.

MOUNTAIN OPERATIONS

Snowcat Operations Manager · Fuel Distribution Manager DEC 2018 — APR 2025

Chugach Powder Guides · Girdwood, AK

- Led 10+ skilled operators and maintenance crew; built a culture of safety, efficiency, and teamwork.
- Implemented control measures that reduced helicopter charter cancellations from human and mechanical factors.
- Strict compliance with Alaska State regulations governing heli-cat operations and environmental protection.

CERTIFICATIONS & IDENTIFICATION

USCG LICENSES & RATINGS

USCG Master 100-Ton Near Coastal (sail/auxiliary) · Radar Observer · Unlimited Able Seafarer · Unlimited ARPA · Assistance Towing · FCC Marine Radio Operator · Lifeboat Operator · Wiper · Steward's Department (F.H.) · USCG Medical Certification

STCW

STCW II/4 — RFPNW · STCW VI/1 — Basic Training · STCW VI/2 — Survival Craft & Rescue Boats (PSC) · STCW VI/3 — Advanced Firefighting

SAFETY, RESCUE, ID

PADI Rescue Diver · First Aid & CPR · OSHA Hazmat · FEMA Rescue Technician · Various NIMS · UFSAC Firefighter · TWIC · US Passport · Global Entry · 200-Ton Oceans Master / Mate (filed, awaiting return) · VPDS (filed, awaiting return)

EDUCATION

Miami University — Oxford, OH

May 2014 · B.S. Business Marketing · Minor in Naval Science

Activities: Delta Sigma Pi Business Fraternity · Full-time Firefighter / EMT · Airport Manager · Rock Climbing Course Instructor